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Budding Entrepreneurs Forum

VENTURES VOYAGE

ENTREPRENEURSHIP IN NICHE MARKETS: UNVEILING HIDDEN OPPORTUNITIES

MIT WPU KOTHRUD PUNE | THE BUSINESS PLANET | BUDDINGENTREPRENEURS.COM

INTRODUCTION

ENTREPRENEURSHIP IN NICHE MARKETS: UNVEILING HIDDEN OPPORTUNITIES

With more than 2.4 million creators emerging in the marketplace, it has opened endless possibilities and opportunities for entrepreneurs, businesses, and influencers to position themselves as a go-to brand for their audience

Keeping the positive side aside, it is a fact that the marketplace is also getting overcrowded due to the high level of competition among the creators.

Hence, focusing on niche markets allows creators and brands to cater to specific customer needs, stand out from the competition, and build a loyal, engaged audience.

What is Niche Marketing?

Niche marketing is a form of marketing geared towards targeting a specific audience, united by needs, preferences, and identity.

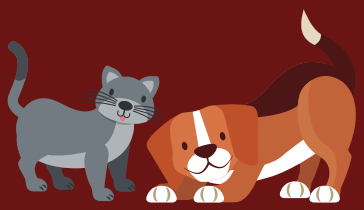
In the simple words, niche marketing is a specific portion of the market's demographics and target audience.

For example, Square. Square is a powerful POS software that enables store owners to accept credit card payments using phones or tablets. It revolutionized small and mobile businesses by offering an ultra-mobile card reader that plugs into an iPhone, making credit card processing accessible to those without traditional merchant accounts. Additionally, Square provides a suite of online marketing tools to help small businesses connect with and engage their target audiences.

Niche marketing occurs when the business takes a step towards specializing in a particular product or a service and then performs its marketing endeavours around these groups. Niche markets may be small, but they hold big opportunities for success.

SAMIKSHA PAZARE
MBA FINANCE

TECH TAILS: HOW TECHNOLOGY IS TRANSFORMING PET CARE



In recent years, the pet tech industry has experienced remarkable growth, revolutionizing how we care for our furry companions. This article explores pet tech's evolution, current trends, and prospects in the pet care industry. The real boom began in the 2010s leading with the advancement of pet tech. The notable current trends are as follows:

- **Wearable Devices & Smart Toys:** Smart collars, GPS, and health monitors are now commonplace, allowing pet owners to track their pets' activity levels and overall health. Devices like the Fi Smart Collar and Whistle Health are popular products of Fi and Whistle Labs Inc.
- **Automatic Feeders and Water Dispensers**: Devices like the Pet Safe Smart Feed Automatic Feeder ensure pets are fed on time, even when owners are away, while water dispensers promote better hydration.

Numerous pet tech startups are making waves in the industry and are transforming how we care for our beloved companions, offering innovative solutions, as technology continues to evolve, the future of pet care looks bright, with endless possibilities for enhancing the lives of pets and the start-up world as with noticeable pet tech startups on the floor.

Petnow Inc.: Focuses on biometric identification solutions for pets, using facial recognition technology to help reunite lost pets with their owners.

Embark: A dog DNA testing company provides insights into canine health and potential disease risks, helping pet owners make informed decisions about their pets' care.

GARIMA PRASAD ,
MBA – BANKING AND FINANCIAL SERVICES

The Rise of Experiential Travel and Micro Tourism

Travel has evolved from simple sightseeing to immersive experiences that connect travelers deeply with local culture, traditions, and nature. Experiential travel focuses on creating meaningful memories, while micro tourism highlights exploring hidden gems close to home. Together, they offer exciting opportunities for entrepreneurs to innovate in the travel industry.

Modern travelers crave authenticity.

Micro-tourism encourages travelers to explore nearby destinations rather than traveling far. It promotes eco-friendly travel, supports local businesses, and reduces the environmental impact of tourism. Entrepreneurs can create curated itineraries, pop-up markets, or unique homestays in less-traveled areas, offering comfort with a touch of tradition.

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Opportunities for Entrepreneurs

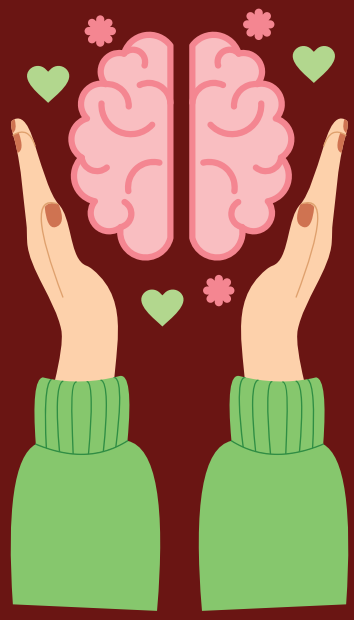
- Local Guides and Storytellers
- Sustainable Stays
- Customized Packages
- Tech Platforms

SAARA NAWAB
MBA (BUSINESS ANALYTICS)

Navigating Mental Health
The Synergy of Tech and Awareness

Mental health awareness has fostered a supportive environment for individuals seeking support, the reduction in stigma surrounding mental health and the easy access to care has led multiple startups to surge in this technological era. This paradigm shift around mental health has led to production of digital platforms, including apps and online therapy services, which has acted as a boon for individuals who do not seek the traditional therapy method.

Entrepreneurs have been leveraging technology to fabricate innovative solutions such as digital therapy platforms, mood-tracking apps, and AI-driven chatbots that offer immediate support. Apps such as Calm and Innerhour are leading the way in this domain. The app Calm offers guided meditations, sleep stories, and anxiety relief techniques, appealing to a tech-savvy audience seeking immediate support for mental health challenges. Innerhour provides a more personalized approach to mental health, wherein the users select their specific concerns such as anxiety or depression, and are connected with trained psychologists. As the world transitioned into the online world, we saw the development of apps and websites such as Talkspace and BetterHelp, providing accessible and flexible counseling. Online therapy caters to the needs and connects an individual to a licensed therapist through various formats like video calls, and live chats making it more inclusive and convenient.



With society being more attuned to mental wellness, the entrepreneurial landscape is a ripe domain for entrepreneurs looking to make a positive impact.

SANJANA KASHYAP
MBA HR

Vintage and Sustainable Fashion
A Modern Trend Rooted in Timelessness

In a fast-fashion-dominated world, vintage and sustainable fashion have come as a fresh breeze. These movements speak directly to the heart of the current generation, which values individuality, environmental consciousness, and a touch of timeless style.

However, with the charm and stories associated with vintage fashion, one can stand out from the rest of mass-produced clothing. While going from retro blazers to hand-me-down dresses, each one brings with it history but adds a touch of exclusivity to the wardrobe. But beyond nostalgic appeal, vintage is inherently sustainable: this is about reusing what already exists, reducing waste, and bypassing the environmental toll of new production.

Sustainable fashion takes this ethos further by advocating for ethical production practices, the use of eco-friendly materials, and support for brands that prioritize fair wages and minimal carbon footprints. For Gen Z and Millennials, who value transparency and purpose-driven choices, sustainable fashion is not just a style but a statement.

In short, incorporating vintage and sustainable fashion into everyday life does not mean sacrificing trends-it is more about redefining them. Pairing vintage finds with modern staples or choosing brands with eco-conscious missions allows us to look great while doing good. This blend of style and sustainability makes these movements not just relevant but revolutionary for our time.

NIRJALA
TEMGHARE
MBA FINANCE

Personalized Nutrition: A Hidden Gem in the Health Market

Personalized Nutrition is on the rise because consumers seeking diets that fit their specific health needs and preferences. These are driven by health consciousness, technological advancement, and increasing chronic health conditions. More people are now looking for customized diet plans that support their fitness goals, manage health issues such as diabetes, or suit specific lifestyle choices such as veganism, keto, or gluten-free diets.

This is a great opportunity for entrepreneurs to innovate. Consider Cure Fit, for instance blending personalized fitness routines with diet plans, it offers a seamless way for people to reach their health goals.

Exciting Opportunities for Entrepreneurs

1.Customized Meal Delivery: Launch subscription services with meals designed to fit specific health goals, such as keto, vegan, or gluten-free.

2. Nutrition Monitoring Apps: Design apps for monitoring food intake and suggesting related recipes, so the customer can make informed choices when it comes to nutrition.

3. Individualized Nutrition: Is the next market to be disrupted, entrepreneurs stand a chance to make innovative steps towards solving the increasing demand for individualized health and wellness.

4. Nutritionist Platforms: Develop mobile applications that will connect an individual with a certified nutritionist who can design a particular diet plan using health-related data.

SUSHMITA POOJARI
MBA FINANCE

Senior Care Technology in India A Growing Niche for Entrepreneurs

According to a new demographic trend, India, as a nation, will now witness hype in entrepreneurship regarding old-age technology. Rising longevity and infectious family types increase the demand for solutions to geriatric care, which further justifies and contextualizes this burgeoning need.

Elder care at home includes medical consultations at home, physiotherapy, and home care post-hospitalization, among other offerings from companies like **Portea Medical.** A similar holistic service would be available across categories such as emergency response, assisted living support, and regular health monitoring at **Anvayaa Kin Care.**

Care24, Mumbai's giants of aged people home nursing and caregiving, blends the human touch into technology for better services. HealthCare at HOME (HCAH) provides eldercare packages, and physiotherapy associated with chronic disease management, to make it convenient for family members.

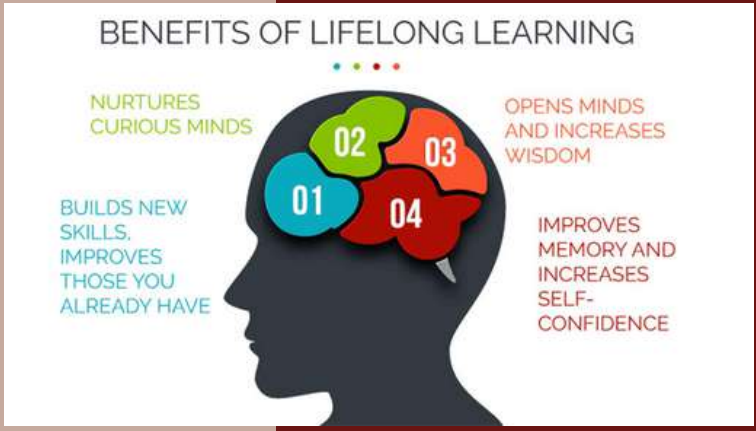
Some startups such as **ElderAid Wellness** have developed programs that address loneliness and social isolation by emphasizing companionship, lifestyle management, and emotional well-being, while others like **Sukino Healthcare** have set up transitional and palliative care services involving rehabilitation and long-term support.

There are ample opportunities in the niche market for building solutions around tech-enabled platforms like wearables, health monitors, senior-friendly apps, and telemedicine. The entrepreneurs will earn tons of money while making great contributions to the well-being of India's elderly population.

MANALI KHADILKAR
MBA – HR

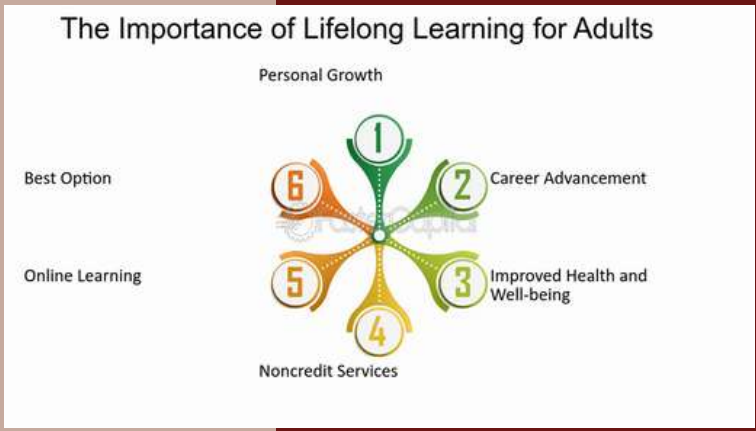
Alternative Education
A Road to Lifelong Learners

In a rapidly changing world, traditional education often fails to keep up with the pace of the modern world. Alternative education has emerged as a strong tool for lifelong learners by combining flexibility, innovation, and relevance. For this generation, which is all about personal and practical experiences, this is a transformative opportunity.



Unlike rigid one-size-fits-all systems, alternative education focuses more on experiential learning, acquiring skills, and creativity. Such entities as Coursera, Khan Academy, and Master Class bring expert-led lessons to just about anyone, anytime, anywhere. Gamified applications, virtual reality (VR) experiences, and workshop interactions make learning not only accessible but also enjoyable.

It caters to different aspirations—be it mastering a new language, upskilling for the tech-driven job market, or pursuing a long-forgotten hobby. Bootcamps and micro-credentials perfectly align with today's need for agility, making learners adapt to AI, sustainability, and digital marketing industries.



This educational renaissance empowers individuals to take charge of their growth. In doing so, it redefines success—not by degrees but by skills, adaptability, and passion. For a generation seeking meaningful, lifelong learning, alternative education is the bridge between ambition and achievement, reshaping futures one learner at a time.

TAPAN KAJAGAR
MBA – FINANCE

LET'S TALK BUSINESS PODCAST INSIGHTS INTO HOSPITALITY WITH ANOOJ BHATIYA

Host: Sohira Kshemkalyani (Member of Budding Entrepreneurs Forum)
Guest: Anooj Bhatiya, Operations Manager, Madeline Cafe

1

PODCAST

In this engaging episode of Let's Talk Business, we dive into the inspiring journey of Mr. Anooj Bhatiya, a seasoned professional in the hospitality industry. With years of experience managing operations and adapting to industry challenges, Anooj offers valuable insights for aspiring entrepreneurs and hospitality enthusiasts alike.

The conversation begins with a glimpse into the role of an operations Manager, highlighting the importance of ensuring smooth daily operations, maintaining product and service consistency, and understanding customer feedback to drive growth. Anooj emphasizes the critical role of Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) in ensuring consistent quality across multiple branches. These procedures form the backbone of customer satisfaction and brand reputation in the competitive cafe market.

Anooj shares his experiences from Novotel Hotel Goa, Santè Spa Cuisine, and Chaayos, delving into his entrepreneurial venture, "Brew," a kiosk-style cafe in Pune. Despite its closure, he reflects on the lessons learned, including the need to adapt to local market preferences, plan finances effectively, and manage operational stress. His candid recounting of challenges offers an authentic look at the ups and downs of running a business.

The discussion also touches on industry dynamics, such as maintaining operational costs below 35-40%, navigating staffing shortages, and evolving with changing consumer preferences. Anooj stresses that brilliant customer experience (BCX) is the cornerstone of success, driving repeat business and fostering loyalty.

Anooj also discusses innovative marketing strategies, such as partnering with brands to create merchandise collaborations and diversifying revenue streams. His advice to budding professionals underscores the importance of networking, internships, and mentorship in shaping a successful career in hospitality.

The episode further explores the differences between business models like Starbucks' QSR approach and bistro-style operations at Madeline Cafe. Anooj emphasizes the need for adaptability and strategic planning, recommending quarterly planning to stay ahead of market trends.

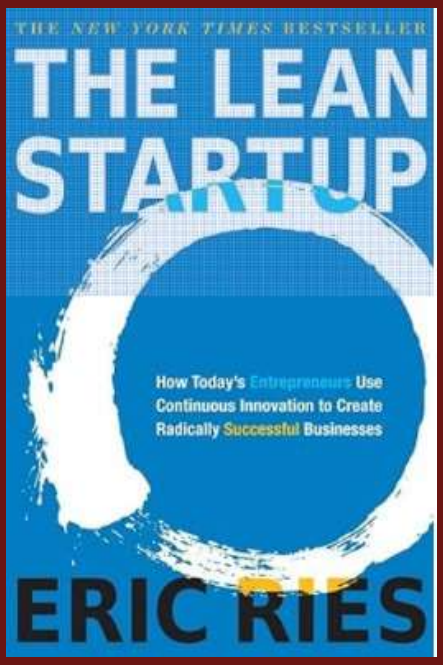
With actionable advice and personal anecdotes, this episode offers a treasure trove of knowledge for anyone interested in the hospitality industry. Whether you're a student, entrepreneur, or seasoned professional, Anooj's insights into operational excellence, resilience, and customer focus are invaluable.

Tune in to Let's Talk Business to uncover what it takes to thrive in the dynamic and ever-evolving hospitality world!

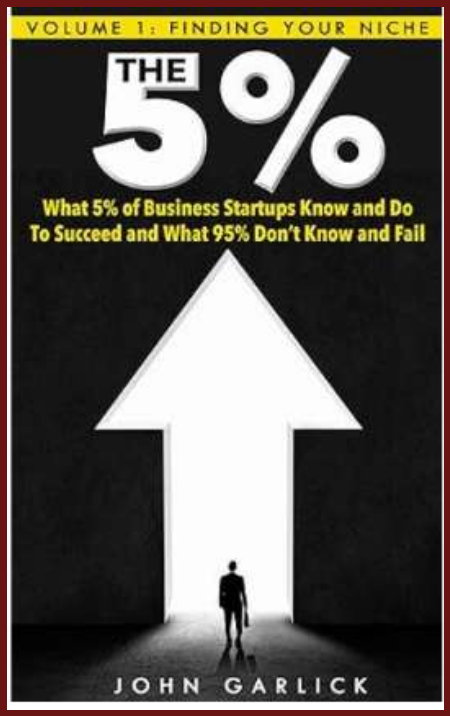
SCAN ME

SUGGESTION BOX

BOOKS



Eric Ries' written "The Lean Start-up" presents a scientific approach to entrepreneurship. It focuses on rapid experimentation, feedback from customers, and iteration. One should validate hypotheses through MVPs. Build-measure-learn loops, innovation accounting, and pivoting in case of failing assumptions are emphasized. Growth can be sustainable either by customer retention, viral marketing, or paid acquisition.



Finding your Niche (BOOK 1), John Garlick guides entrepreneurs to identify a successful business path. The author explains the strategies used by the successful 5% of the start-ups, while the other 95% fail because they lack an understanding of it. The book also provides an elaborate structure for reviewing objectives, competencies, and market opportunities to help pinpoint a profitable niche.

SUGGESTION BOX

COURSES

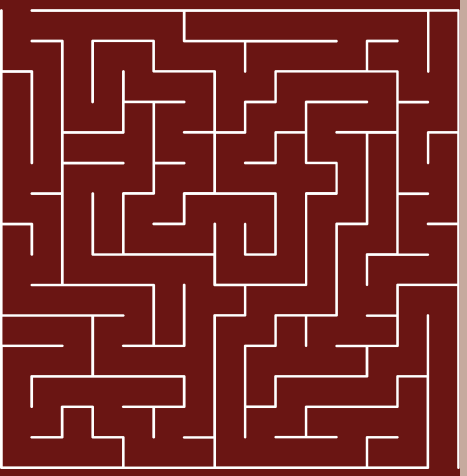
BECOMING AN ENTREPRENEUR BY MIT

This course will provide you with how to venture down the entrepreneurial path and get you armed with the equipment to cut through the typical barriers in setting up ba usiness. This course follows LaunchX's successful approach, using MIT's Disciplined Entrepreneurship, lean methodologies, and design thinking, so participants can pass through designing innovative business ideas, studying markets, designing, and validating their products, as well as pitching them powerfully.

This Coursera SEO course equips learners with the essential skills to optimize websites and enhance online visibility. Topics include competitive analysis, social media brand recognition, technical SEO tasks like creating site maps and managing site errors, and audience analysis to build buyer personas. Practical expertise is gained to boost rankings and drive engagement effectively.

VARAD MULGUND
MBA BUSINESS ANALYTICS

Riddles



1.I'm the face of your business, known far and wide, I tell your story with pride. I'm in logos, ads, and every guide. Without me, your business might hide. What am I?

2.I'm a guide in your way, With goals and steps for every day. Investors love me, that's no lie, Without me, your dreams might die. What am I?

3.I'm the voice that spreads the word. Through social media, I'm often heard. I build your presence, loud and clear, Without me, few will hear. What am I?

4.I'm the spark that starts the flame, With creativity, I play the game. I solve problems, and think outside the box, Without me, progress locks. What am I?

5.I'm an aura within your walls, With values and norms, I call. I shape behavior, big and small, Without me, your team might fall. What am I?

6.I'm the web that you build, With connections, your dreams are fulfilled. I open doors, new deals are sealed, Without me, growth is concealed. What am I?

ANSWERS:
1. Branding
2. Business Plan
3. Marketing
4. Innovation
5. Organisationsal culture
6. Networking

KRISHNA GUTTE
MBA HR

Success Stories of Indian Startups

Larsen&Toubro (L&T) - Infrastructure & Engineering Industry

Larsen & Toubro (L&T), founded in 1938 by Danish engineers Henning Holck-Larsen and Soren Kristian Toubro in Mumbai, is a leading multinational conglomerate in infrastructure and engineering. Initially focused on imports, L&T expanded into manufacturing and engineering services, playing a pivotal role in India's development. Renowned for executing complex projects, it has contributed to world-class infrastructure, including airports, highways, power plants, and water projects. Operating in over 30 countries, L&T is globally recognized for its precision, innovation, and contributions to technological advancements and economic growth.

Golden Crest Education and Services Limited - Education & Skill

Development Industry Golden Crest Education and Services Limited is a leader in skill-based education and vocational training, aimed at bridging the gap between academics and industry needs.Focusing on sectors like IT, retail, healthcare, and finance, it equips students with modern job-ready skills. Collaborating with state governments and industries, the organization delivers impactful programs and career opportunities. With innovative teaching and career-focused courses, Golden Crest is transforming lives and strengthening the nation's skill ecosystem.

GAIL(India) Limited - Energy&Natural Gas Industry GAIL

GAIL (India) Limited, established in 1984, is a state-owned leader in India's natural gas and energy sector. With an extensive pipeline network spanning thousands of kilometers, GAIL supports clean energy goals through natural gas transmission, petrochemicals, LPG, and renewable energy.
The company has been pivotal in reducing carbon emissions by promoting natural gas and investing in solar and wind energy projects. Focused on energy security and sustainability, GAIL plays a key role in India's transition to a greener economy.

Cipla - Pharmaceutical Industry

Founded in 1935 by Dr. Khwaja Abdul Hamied, Cipla is a leading Indian pharmaceutical company dedicated to affordable healthcare. Renowned for making antiretroviral drugs accessible for HIV/AIDS treatment in Africa, Cipla supplies essential medicines to over 100 countries. Its innovations in respiratory, oncology, and cardiac care reflect its strong focus on research and social responsibility, improving millions of lives globally.

Kalyan Jewellers - Jewellery Retail Industry

Founded in 1993 by T.S. Kalyanaraman, Kalyan Jewellers is a trusted name in the jewelry retail industry. From a single store in Thrissur, Kerala, it has grown to over 150 showrooms across India and the Middle East, offering designs that blend tradition and modernity.

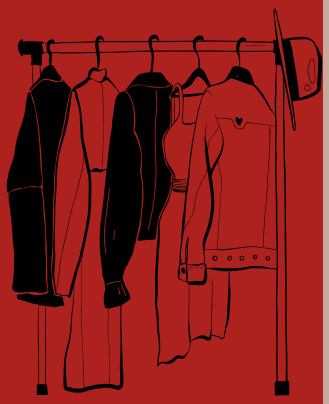
Initiatives like 'My Kalyan' connect with rural customers, while celebrity-led campaigns enhance its brand identity. With a focus on quality, transparency, and customer satisfaction, Kalyan Jewellers is a global leader in the jewelry market.

Zerodha - Stockbroking Industry

Launched in 2010 by Nithin and Nikhil Kamath, Zerodha revolutionized stockbroking in India with its low-cost, transparent trading model. Offering zero brokerage for equity investments and minimal fees for other transactions, it made investing accessible to millions. Its platform, Kite, provides advanced trading tools, while the Varsity program promotes financial literacy. Today, Zerodha is India's largest stockbroker, with over 12 million clients and billions in daily transactions, setting new benchmarks in the financial services industry.

PRIYANKA NAGAR
MBA IB

Conclusion



Niche markets provide businesses with a chance to create meaningful value by focusing on specific needs. These markets allow companies to stand out, build loyal relationships, and deliver tailored solutions. Across industries, innovative entrepreneurs are transforming niche spaces into impactful opportunities.

For example, in mental health, platforms like Calm and Innerhour offer guided meditations and personalized therapy, while apps like Talkspace provide flexible online counseling. These solutions make mental health care accessible and convenient. Similarly, vintage and sustainable fashion appeal to environmentally conscious individuals. Vintage clothing promotes reusing items, while sustainable fashion supports ethical production and eco-friendly materials. This movement blends style with responsibility.

In the travel industry, experiential travel and micro-tourism are reshaping how people explore. Travelers now seek authentic cultural experiences and eco-friendly local destinations. Entrepreneurs respond with food tours, heritage walks, and curated homestays in hidden gems.

By tapping into niche markets, businesses can create ventures that resonate deeply with their audience. These markets prove that success isn't just about scale; it's about providing value, inspiring change, and building lasting connections in meaningful ways.

TANAYA ZAD

MBA FINANCE

MEET THE COMMITTEE

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Shivam Dewangan	Vice President
Charu Dutt Joshi	General Secretary
Vaishnavi Srivastava	General Advisor & Treasurer
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Vishal Parashar	Event Co Head
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Subhash	Photography Co Head
Vishal Jadhav	Website Developer Head
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Meera Dharra	Core member
Kanishka Sharma	Core member
Ishika Talapatra	Core member
Rishikesh Mandaniya	Core member
Harish Sahu	Core member
Pinkesh Tawade	Core member

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Nirjala Temghare	Article 4
Sushmita Poojari	Article 5
Manali Khadilkar	Article 6
Tapan Kajagar	Article 7
Yash Mutha	Podcast
Varad Mulgund	Suggetion Box
Priyanka Nagar	Success Stories
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Famiya Kashani	Riddles
Khushi Shethia	Podcast
Khushi Shethia	Conclusion
Maitreyee Joglekar	Alignment
Maitreyee Joglekar	Meet the committee

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Under the Guidance of

PROF. DR. VINITA KALE — **Coordinator, Budding Entrepreneurs Forum**

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Note: Articles should be on topics related to Entrepreneurship along with your name, specialization, year, contact number , email id and a formal photograph.
Word limit: 250-300 words.